RETAIL BANKING RESEARCH

Global Retail Banking Customer Experience Survey 2026

Why satisfied customers are ready to leave, and how banks can turn passive satisfaction into genuine preference.

synpulse

Executive summary

To better understand how retail banking customers perceive their relationship with their bank, Synpulse surveyed customers worldwide across the seven themes below.

500+
customers surveyed

20+
markets covered

Loyalty · Digital experience · Trust · Advice · Personalisation · Service quality · Relationship depth

The results reveal a sector that has largely succeeded in digitising banking, but has been less successful in building deeper customer relationships.

Customers consistently describe banks as convenient and functional, yet relatively few see them as trusted partners or providers that genuinely understand them.

The findings can be distilled into nine key insights.

Each is previewed here with the measure that anchors it later in this report.

01

Satisfaction is high, but loyalty is thin

Many customers report being satisfied with their bank, yet a majority would consider switching if the process were easier. Retention is often driven by inertia rather than genuine attachment.

–10 Net Promoter Score

62% would switch if easy

02

A strong mobile app is merely table stakes. Speed and reliability are critical

Delays remain common, and many customers report anxiety when transactions do not complete as expected.

74% felt anxiety over a delayed transaction

03

Most customers do not feel their bank understands them

Customers believe their bank knows a great deal about them, yet few feel understood or receive relevant interactions.

34% feel their bank really knows them

04

Customers want a partner. Most describe a utility

Customers expect banks to play an active role during moments such as buying a home, starting a family or planning for retirement, but few believe this happens consistently today. It is the widest demand-supply gap in this survey.

67% want the right product at the right life moment

05

Data is the fuel, but customers set the terms

Willingness to share data falls steeply with age and is consistently conditional on a visible return. Access to the data that powers personalisation has to be earned segment by segment rather than assumed.

80% of 18–24s are willing to share data

06

Fragmented wallets, but many would consolidate

Many would deepen their engagement with a single provider that delivered a genuinely integrated experience.

47% would consolidate with a connected provider

07

A majority would pay for a materially better experience

Willingness to pay spans the income scale, challenging the assumption that customers focus solely on price.

70% of $150k+ earners would pay for a premium tier

08

Onboarding is where prospective customers are lost

Lengthy processes, repeated data collection and hard-to-reach support erode otherwise strong digital experiences.

41% abandoned an application before completing

09

Human support still matters at the hardest moments

Customers accept self-service for routine tasks, but when the stakes are high they want a capable person quickly. The handover between digital and human channels is where banks most often fall short.

79% want a human for complex or sensitive issues

METHODOLOGY

469 decision-makers. 20+ markets.

The survey was conducted with household banking decision-makers between June and July 2026. Of 516 total entries, 469 form the valid base used throughout this report, after screening for retail account ownership and primary or joint responsibility for household banking decisions. Respondents span more than 20 markets across Asia-Pacific, Europe, the Middle East and the Americas, and every income band from under $30k to $150k and above.

All monetary values are shown in US dollars, and income refers to annual personal income before tax. Unless stated otherwise, percentages are calculated over these 469 valid responses. Respondents were recruited through Synpulse's own networks, so the findings are indicative of those surveyed rather than statistically representative of any national population; figures are unweighted. A full methodology and data annex appears at the end of this report.

80%
bank primarily on mobile

85%
use an incumbent bank

100%
household decision-makers

READING THIS REPORT

Percentages are calculated on the 469 valid responses unless a sub-group base is shown. Where this report highlights a gap or a segment, treat the finding as directional: it describes the customers surveyed, and is intended to frame the questions a bank should ask of its own data rather than to settle them.

INSIGHT 01

Satisfaction is high, but loyalty is thin.

Satisfaction scores suggest healthy relationships. Net Promoter Score points to something closer to quiet tolerance.

–10

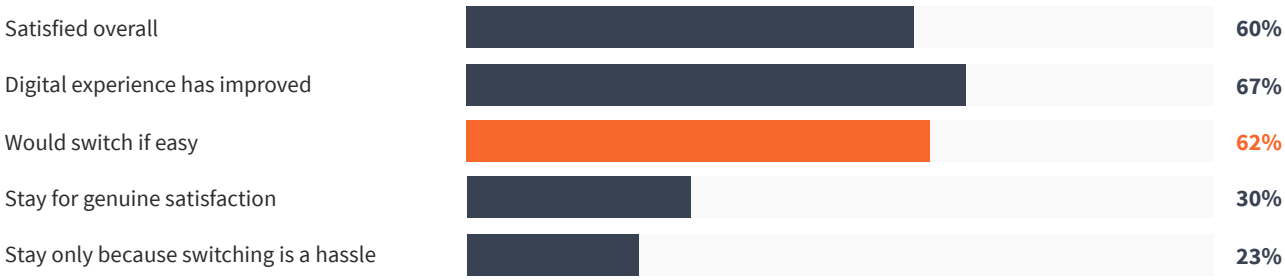
Net Promoter Score

Detractors outnumber promoters by about three to two. 35% would actively discourage others from using their bank, while just 25% would recommend it; the remainder sit in passive indifference.

At first glance, the results reassure. Three in five customers describe themselves as satisfied, and two-thirds say their digital experience has improved over the past two years. On these measures alone, the relationship could easily be read as healthy.

The picture looks more fragile once behaviour, rather than sentiment, enters the frame. 62% would switch if it were made easy, while only 30% remain due to genuine satisfaction. Among those who stay, the most common single reason after genuine satisfaction is that switching is simply too much hassle (23%): moving payroll, direct debits and cards. The two figures describe the same underlying force, friction, from two directions.

FIGURE 1 · EXPERIENCE IS RATED WELL; LOYALTY BEHAVIOUR IS WEAKER



KEY TAKEAWAYS

Any competitor that lowers the cost of switching, through open banking, account portability or a better onboarding experience, can put the primary relationship at risk. Relying on friction to retain customers is not a durable position.

INSIGHT 02

A strong mobile app is merely table stakes. Speed and reliability are critical.

A decade of digital investment has raised the baseline. Eighty percent of surveyed customers bank primarily through a mobile app, and three in five rate that app highly. A strong app has largely become the price of entry rather than a differentiator: once most banks offer one, a good app no longer sets any of them apart. That is also why app ratings sit around three in five rather than near-universal; customers now judge their bank against the best digital experiences they use anywhere, so the bar keeps rising faster than incremental app improvements can clear it.

That raises the bar rather than settling it. Surveyed customers appear to have recalibrated their expectations around the best digital experiences they use anywhere, and most now treat instant confirmation as the default. When performance slips, almost three-quarters report anxiety over a delayed or pending transaction. The survey does not isolate who customers blame for a given failure, but the reputational cost tends to fall on the bank rather than the network or the device.

FIGURE 2 · SPEED AND RELIABILITY ARE NOW BASELINE EXPECTATIONS

The emotional response is the striking part. For almost three-quarters of surveyed customers, a delayed transaction is not read as a minor inconvenience; it triggers anxiety about whether their money is safe. Against a backdrop of instant messaging and real-time payments, a spinning loading icon can read as a signal that something has gone wrong, and that concern tends to attach to the bank rather than the underlying network. For these customers, reliability behaves like an emotional contract, not merely a technical one.

KEY TAKEAWAYS

Banks should be investing as much in app robustness as they do in app features. A strong mobile experience is now expected by customers and provides limited competitive advantage on its own. What increasingly shapes perception is whether the app performs consistently when customers need it most.

INSIGHT 03

Most customers do not feel their bank understands them.

Banks hold some of the richest first-party data of any organisation in a customer's life: where they spend, when they are paid, what they are saving toward, and how their circumstances change over time. Yet only a third of respondents feel genuinely understood, and just a quarter find their bank's offers relevant. The raw material for personalisation exists; the survey suggests it is not yet being used well.

The gap is compounded by basic data hygiene. Two in five respondents say they have been asked at least once to re-enter details their bank already held. It is a small friction that sends a large signal: the bank is not joining up what it already knows about them.

FIGURE 3 · DATA IS HELD, BUT NOT TURNED INTO UNDERSTANDING

Read together, these three measures describe a single gap from three angles: data that is held but not connected, marketing that is sent but not relevant, and journeys that ask for information the bank already has. The opportunity is not more data collection but better use of what already sits on file, turning transaction and life-stage signals into genuine understanding rather than generic campaigns.

KEY TAKEAWAYS

On this evidence, personalisation reads less as a marketing opportunity and more as a relationship test. Surveyed customers are asking for relevance at the moments that matter, but most do not yet experience their bank as genuinely useful or timely. The priority is to move from broad campaign logic to life-event engagement, using existing customer signals to show up with the right help, at the right moment, in a way that feels clearly in the customer's interest.

INSIGHT 04

Customers want a partner. Most describe a utility.

Where Insight 03 looked at day-to-day relevance, this looks at the bigger moments. There is clear demand among respondents for banks to engage around real-life events, a mortgage while house-hunting or cover while booking travel, yet few say they experience their bank that way today.

Customers draw a sharp line between a provider and a partner. Two-thirds of respondents want their bank to show up at the moments that matter, with timely, contextual guidance rather than generic cross-sell. This is a demand for advice and presence at life's turning points, not simply for more products.

Reality falls well short. Just over half of respondents feel their bank understands their financial life (52%, a broader measure than the 34% on Insight 03 who feel genuinely known), and only a third credit it with a meaningful role in major decisions such as buying a home, starting a family or planning retirement. For many respondents, the bank is present for transactions but largely absent from the decisions that matter most. One nuance the global figures hide: in some markets, such as Switzerland, customers deliberately use several banks for different needs, so a lower sense of being "known" partly reflects that split rather than pure neglect.

FIGURE 4 · STRONG DEMAND FOR A PARTNER, WEAKER DELIVERY

This is the survey's largest single gap between what customers say they want and what they receive. Unlike price or rates, this gap is almost entirely within the bank's own control. Closing it does not require new products so much as the discipline to engage at the right moment, in the customer's interest rather than to the bank's sales calendar. It is the most direct route from passive satisfaction to genuine preference.

KEY TAKEAWAYS

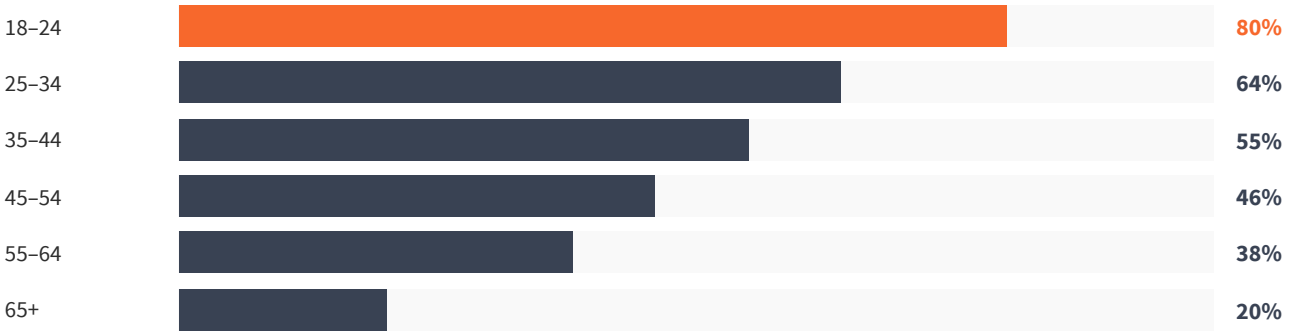
On this evidence, the appetite for a deeper relationship appears real and largely unmet. Life-moment engagement, anticipating needs and showing up with relevant guidance, is what turns a transactional utility into a bank customers would actively choose and recommend.

INSIGHT 05

Data is the fuel, but customers set the terms.

Personalisation runs on data, and willingness to share it is neither uniform nor guaranteed. On a broad measure (any willingness to share), it falls steeply with age, from 80% among under-25s to just 20% among the over-65s, though firm willingness is far lower in every band and the youngest group rests on a very small base (n=15), and is consistently conditional on trust. Most respondents are not opposed to sharing in principle; they are opposed to sharing without a clear and visible return.

FIGURE 5 · ANY WILLINGNESS TO SHARE DATA FOR PERSONALISED SERVICE, BY AGE



% expressing any willingness (slightly or more) to share data for more personalised service. Bases: 18–24 n=15, 25–34 n=166, 35–44 n=127, 45–54 n=80, 55–64 n=37, 65+ n=44. Small bases, especially 18–24, should be read as indicative only.

The age gradient carries a practical warning: a single, blanket approach to data will either over-reach with older customers or under-serve younger ones. The under-35s who are most willing to share are also the most likely to switch, so the data they offer must be repaid quickly in visibly better service. Older customers, by contrast, appear to extend trust only where the value is obvious and the handling is transparent.

The encouraging finding is that willingness and worth move together. The $60–100k and $150k+ segments, the most valuable to deepen and retain, are also among the most willing to share, at around 60% any-willingness. A bank that builds a credible, transparent value exchange is therefore not chasing data for its own sake; it is unlocking precisely the segments where the commercial return is greatest.

KEY TAKEAWAYS

Just under half of respondents (47%) say they will not share data with third parties at all, and willingness elsewhere is mostly tentative; AI advice is trusted mainly when it draws on the customer's own information. The route to data access is a visible value exchange using first-party data, earned segment by segment, not assumed.

INSIGHT 06

Fragmented wallets, but many would consolidate.

Most customers spread their financial lives across several providers. Nearly four in ten hold products with four or more institutions, a current account here, a savings product there, a card or loan somewhere else. This is not loyalty to each; it is the natural result of no single bank having earned the right to the whole relationship.

47%

would consolidate
with a genuinely connected provider, rising to 60% among $60–100k earners

4+

providers held
by nearly four in ten respondents

The opening is real. 47% would consolidate with a provider that offered a genuinely connected experience, and appetite rises to 60% among $60–100k earners, a broad, affluent middle that is actively looking for one financial home. For the bank, consolidation is one of the most direct paths to deeper share of wallet and a more defensible relationship.

Fragmentation is not, in itself, disloyalty, but it is a standing invitation. Every product held elsewhere is revenue and data the primary bank has ceded to a competitor, and every additional provider dilutes the relationship a little further. The customers spreading their money across four or more institutions are not doing so out of preference; they have not yet been given a compelling reason to consolidate (see the demand-supply gap in Figure 4).

That the appetite to consolidate peaks in the $60–100k band is the commercially important detail. This is a broad, affluent middle, old enough to have accumulated several products, wealthy enough to matter, and actively open to a single, connected home for their finances. The prize is not a single cross-sell but the primary relationship itself, made materially harder to unpick.

KEY TAKEAWAYS

Customers have not rejected the idea of a primary bank; they simply have not found one worth consolidating around. Nearly half would bring more of their financial life to a provider that offers a connected experience. The opportunity is to move beyond product ownership and become the financial home customers choose to centralise around.

INSIGHT 07

A majority would pay for a materially better experience.

Willingness to pay is not confined to the wealthy. It is strongest at both ends of the income scale, value-seekers who want guidance and lower fees, and higher earners who want priority service and richer features. In our view, this points to a two-tier proposition rather than a single premium play: an accessible value tier and a genuine premium tier, each priced to the experience it delivers.

64%

of under-$30k earners
would pay for guidance and faster service: a value tier.

70%

of $150k+ earners
would pay for priority service and richer features: a premium tier.

The instinct to treat paid banking as a preserve of the wealthy misreads the data. Willingness to pay is a U-shaped curve: it is highest among the lowest earners, who value guidance, lower fees and help staying in control, and among the highest earners, who will pay for speed, status and richer capability. The two groups want very different things, but both are prepared to pay when the experience is materially better than free.

The strategic implication is a deliberate two-tier design rather than a single mid-market subscription that appeals to neither end. An accessible value tier can broaden the base and deepen engagement among mass-market customers, while a genuine premium tier can serve higher earners in the sample who indicate willingness to pay for a better experience. The survey covers retail banking customers and does not extend to HNW or UHNW segments, so we make no claims about that market here. Concretely, that means designing each tier around benefits customers can name, for example fee transparency, spending controls and faster support at the value end, and priority servicing, richer insights and dedicated help at the premium end, then pricing each to the value delivered. Synpulse has designed and launched tiered propositions of this kind, and in our experience both can be credible new revenue lines rather than discounts in disguise.

KEY TAKEAWAYS

The willingness-to-pay debate is largely settled. Customers will pay when the value is obvious and the experience is materially better than the free alternative. The priority is to design differentiated value and premium tiers with benefits customers can immediately understand, use and justify paying for, not simply package existing products behind a monthly fee.

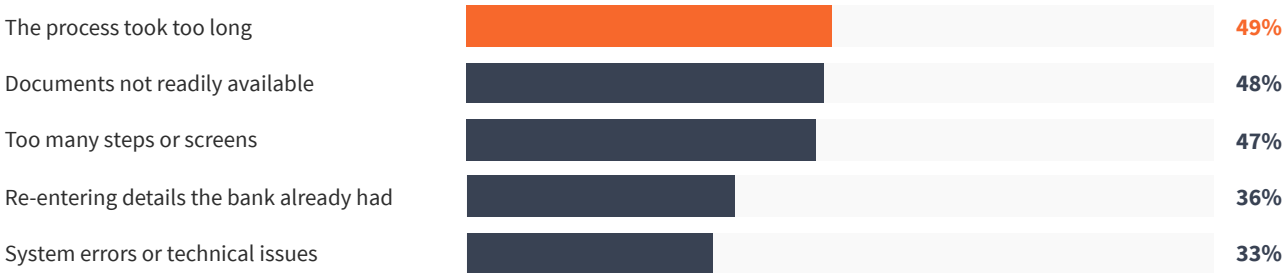
INSIGHT 08

Onboarding is where prospective customers are lost.

Onboarding is where intent turns into attrition. Four in ten respondents who began an application say they abandoned it before completing, a direct commercial loss, measured in lost primary relationships rather than mere friction.

The causes are mundane and fixable: processes that take too long, missing documents, too many steps, and requests to re-enter data the bank already holds. Appetite for high-value digital journeys exists. Almost half would take out a mortgage on their phone.

FIGURE 6 · WHY APPLICATIONS ARE ABANDONED



Every reason on this list is self-inflicted and fixable. None points to a lack of customer intent; all point to process design, length, document demands, repetition and reliability. A third abandon because they were asked to re-enter information the bank already held is the clearest indictment: the data existed, but the journey ignored it. Each abandoned application is a customer who wanted the product and was turned away at the door.

KEY TAKEAWAYS

The biggest barrier to growth is often not demand, but the journey itself. Customers are increasingly willing to complete even complex financial products digitally, yet many abandon applications because the process is slow, repetitive or fragmented. The opportunity is to redesign onboarding around customer convenience, pre-filling known information, reducing steps and removing friction, so that customer intent translates into completed relationships rather than preventable drop-offs.

INSIGHT 09

Human support still matters at the hardest moments.

Digital-first does not mean digital-only. When stakes are high, customers still want a person, and too often the experience falls short.

For everyday tasks, customers are content to self-serve. But when the stakes rise, a suspected fraud, a disputed charge, a bereavement, four in five still want to reach a capable human being, quickly and without friction. The handover is where banks stumble. A third have to repeat their issue to several people, and a third experience inconsistency moving between mobile, web and support. The safety net exists, but for many it is still frayed.

79%
want a human
for complex or sensitive issues

35%
repeat themselves
to several people

33%
hit inconsistency
across mobile, web and support

The lesson is not that digital has been oversold, but that the two channels are too often built as separate worlds. The pattern is consistent: people accept self-service for routine tasks but want a capable person at the highest-stress moments. When a third then have to repeat their story to several people, the bank compounds a difficult moment with a frustrating one, precisely when goodwill is most at stake.

KEY TAKEAWAYS

A digital-first strategy must still preserve, and actively improve, the human safety net. Seamless escalation and cross-channel continuity are now part of the digital experience, not separate from it.

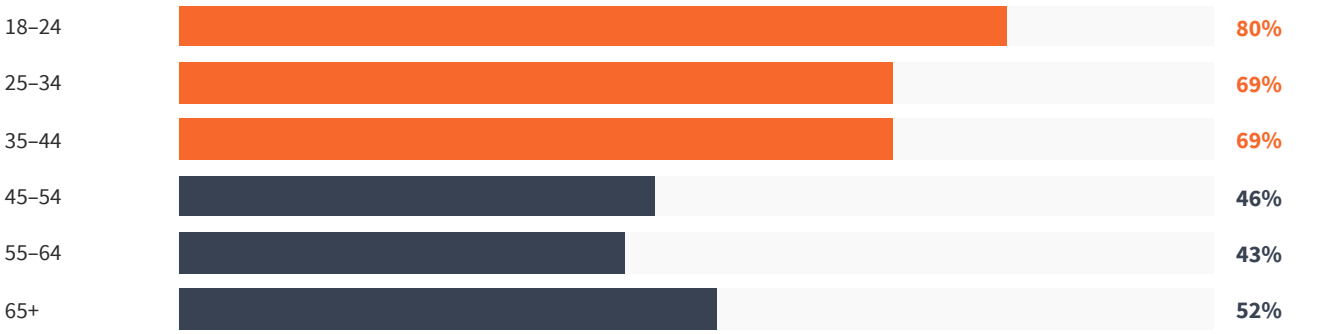
SEGMENT VIEW

Switching risk falls sharply with age.

This page takes the switching finding from Insight 01 down to the segment level. Aggregate figures conceal significant variation, and the clearest opportunities emerge at the segment and market level.

Age is the strongest predictor of flight risk. Eight in ten under-25s and roughly seven in ten 25–44s would switch if it were easy; among the over-55s that falls to around half. The young are barely tethered.

FIGURE 7 · WOULD SWITCH IF SWITCHING WERE MADE EASY, BY AGE



% who would switch if switching were made easy, by age band (same measure as Insight 01). Orange = above the 60% average. Bases per band as noted in the annex.

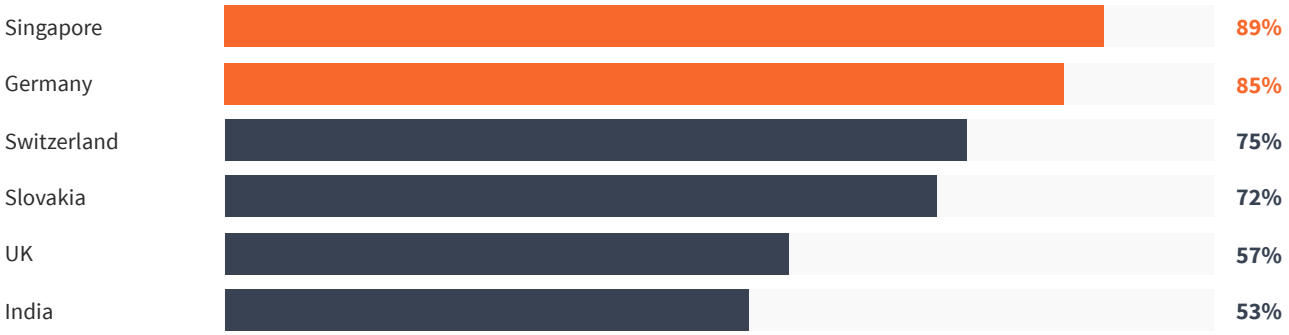
The implication is not to chase the young at any cost, but to recognise that different cohorts are held by different things: the young by experience, the old by trust and inertia.

SEGMENT VIEW (CONT'D)

Singapore and Germany feel the least understood.

The personalisation gap looks widest in the most digitally advanced and digital-bank-pressured markets, though several market bases are small and should be read as indicative.

FIGURE 8 · DO NOT FEEL THEIR BANK KNOWS THEM, BY COUNTRY



% who do not feel their bank knows them, by country. Bases vary and several are small (Germany n=27, UK n=28); markets below ~30 responses are indicative only. Figures are unweighted.

WHAT THIS MEANS MARKET BY MARKET

Singapore

HIGHEST RISK

Demanding and digitally sophisticated; 76% open to switching. The benchmark is increasingly super-apps, not other banks. (n=45.)

Germany

DIGITAL-BANK PRESSURE

33% already use a digital bank. Weak fee clarity and a wide personalisation gap leave incumbents exposed. (Small base: n=27.)

India

TRUST GAP

Largest market in the sample (n=161); 50% want embedded banking but only 34% show any willingness to share data. Trust must be established first.

Switzerland

WEALTH MINDSET

Customers value advice over products and are relatively data-open at 62%. Low interest in embedded banking.

UK

MOST STABLE

Highest satisfaction (68%), lowest switching intent (39%), yet 68% want embedded banking.

Slovakia

CHALLENGER PRESSURE

Solid app experience, but Revolut and mBank are gaining ground and loyalty remains soft.

PRIORITIES

Five priorities to strengthen loyalty.

Our recommendations, grounded in the survey evidence. Each is paired with a baseline metric from the survey that a bank can track over time.

1

Close the personalisation gap with first-party data.

Engage customers at relevant moments using the bank's own data, e.g. mortgage guidance when browsing property, savings prompts around income changes, with a transparent value exchange.

BASELINE (SURVEY)
"Knows me": 34% today

2

Earn the right to be a partner, not a utility.

Move from selling products to supporting life decisions. Only 34% see their bank as meaningful in major moments, against 67% who want it, the widest demand-supply gap in the survey.

BASELINE (SURVEY)
"Meaningful role": 34% today

3

Redesign onboarding to the standard set elsewhere.

Instrument the funnel end to end, remove re-entry of known data, cut steps and pre-fill from open banking or national ID. Every abandoned application is a lost primary product.

BASELINE (SURVEY)
Abandonment: 41% today

4

Make the case to hold the whole relationship.

Bring accounts, savings, investments, insurance and credit into one connected experience. Focus first on $60–100k earners, where consolidation appetite reaches 60%.

BASELINE (SURVEY)
Consolidation appetite: 47% (60% at $60–100k)

5

Earn retention rather than rely on friction.

Invest in the drivers of genuine advocacy, resolving issues before they are raised, keeping people involved for sensitive matters, and maintaining consistency across channels, so that customers stay by choice rather than by inertia.

BASELINE (SURVEY)
NPS: –10 today

BY SEGMENT

Different segments call for different priorities.

The five priorities apply across the board, but their emphasis and sequencing differ by segment. Segments here are defined primarily by income band; the ages shown are typical profiles rather than strict cut-offs, and income and age overlap only partly.

EMERGING AFFLUENT OPPORTUNITY AS A POTENTIAL FOCUS AREA

$30–100k earners · typically 25–44

Feel least understood, up to 78%

Digitally native, mobile-first

Most open to consolidating providers

Priority: life-moment engagement, a fuller relationship

MASS MARKET

Under $30k · value-focused

70% would switch if easy, the highest

47% want more personalised guidance

64% open to a value-priced tier

Priority: lower fees, confidence tools, clear pricing

MOST FRAGMENTED

Established affluent · $150k+

61% use four or more providers

Only 34% would consolidate; they choose deliberately

70% open to premium; 57% will share data

Priority: win on each product's merits, not lock-in

RELATIONSHIP-LED

55+ · branch and phone-first

Most satisfied, least willing to share data (20% at 65+)

Least reliant on the mobile app

Access to a person remains essential

Priority: protect trust, reliability and human support

NEXT STEPS

Where to start.

The findings in this report point to a clear agenda, and none of the five priorities require waiting for further data to begin. The most valuable next step is to translate the global benchmark into a view of your own customers: where your bank sits on each measure, which segments carry the most risk and the most opportunity, and where the quickest wins lie.

HOW SYNPULSE CAN HELP

Diagnostic

Where your bank stands on each finding, measured against your own customer data alongside the global benchmark.

Personalisation strategy

Operating model, data foundations and use-case design, drawn from live implementations rather than theory.

Onboarding & journey redesign

End-to-end review and rebuild of the application journey, using our accelerators and delivery experience across 20+ banks.

Premium tier design & launch

Proposition design, commercial modelling and go-to-market for value and premium banking tiers.

ANNEX

Methodology and data

This annex sets out how the survey was designed, fielded and analysed, together with the respondent profile and the questionnaire. It follows the spirit of recognised survey-disclosure standards (for example AAPOR) so that readers can judge the findings for themselves. The study is intended as an indicative, directional read of the customers surveyed, not as a statistically representative measure of any national market.

A. Research design and fieldwork

Sponsor and purpose. The research was designed, sponsored and analysed by Synpulse to explore the gap between stated satisfaction and genuine loyalty in retail banking.

Instrument. A structured online questionnaire combining single-choice, multiple-choice and scaled items. The full question wording is reproduced in section F.

Recruitment and sample type. Respondents were recruited through Synpulse's own networks and distribution rather than a probability panel. This is a non-probability, self-selected sample; findings should be read as indicative of those surveyed.

Fieldwork. Responses were collected between June and July 2026.

B. Completion and exclusions

A total of 516 responses were received. Following screening, 47 were excluded and 469 form the valid base used throughout this report: 11 respondents did not hold a retail bank account; 36 respondents were not the primary or joint household banking decision-maker. Free-text and out-of-scope entries were reviewed during cleaning. Unless stated otherwise, all percentages are calculated on the 469 valid responses; sub-group results use the bases shown alongside each chart and in section C.

C. Respondent profile (valid base, n=469)

BY MARKET

Market	Responses	Share
India	161	34%
Switzerland	52	11%
Slovakia	47	10%
Singapore	45	10%
United Kingdom	28	6%
Germany	27	6%
Other markets (17)	109	23%

BY AGE

Age band	Responses	Share
18–24	15	3%
25–34	166	35%
35–44	127	27%
45–54	80	17%
55–64	37	8%
65+	44	9%

BY ANNUAL PERSONAL INCOME (USD, BEFORE TAX)

Income band	Responses	Share
Under $30,000	120	26%
$30,000–$59,999	109	23%
$60,000–$99,999	87	19%
$100,000–$149,999	66	14%
$150,000 or more	87	19%

BY PRIMARY CHANNEL AND BANK TYPE

Profile	Responses	Share
Mobile app (primary channel)	377	80%
Desktop / web	57	12%
Branch / phone / other	35	8%
Incumbent bank	398	85%
Digital bank	71	15%

D. Weighting, bases and measures

Weighting. No statistical weighting has been applied; all figures are unweighted. Because the sample is concentrated in a few markets (India is the largest at 34% of the base), global figures are influenced by those markets.

Sub-group bases. Results for individual markets, age bands and income groups rest on smaller bases, shown alongside the relevant charts. Markets with fewer than about 30 responses (for example Germany, n=27, and the United Kingdom, n=28) are reported as indicative only.

How key measures are defined. "Satisfied" refers to respondents rating their bank "very" or "extremely" satisfied (60%); the remaining 40% are moderately satisfied or lower. Net Promoter Score is promoters (9–10) minus detractors (0–6), giving –10. "Would switch if it were easy" combines "moderately", "very" and "extremely" likely (62%). "Willing to share data" on the age chart counts any willingness (slightly or more); firm willingness is lower. No composite index was constructed; figures are simple frequencies and top-box combinations.

E. Limitations and appropriate use

The sample is non-probability and self-selected, so results are indicative of the respondents surveyed rather than representative of national populations.

Market coverage is uneven and concentrated; several country and demographic bases are small and should be read with caution.

All data is self-reported and reflects stated attitudes and recalled behaviour at a point in time.

Figures are unweighted; where this report highlights a market or segment, the relevant base size is shown so readers can judge reliability.

F. Questionnaire

The survey comprised the following questions, shown with the response options offered (screening questions first). "Other" and free-text answers were reviewed during data cleaning.

1. Do you currently have a retail bank account (checking, savings, or current account) that you use for personal banking?
Yes · No

2. Are you the primary or joint decision-maker for your household's banking and financial services?
Yes, primary decision-maker · Yes, joint decision-maker · No

3. What is your age?
18–24 · 25–34 · 35–44 · 45–54 · 55–64 · 65+

4. What is your gender?
Male · Female · Prefer not to say

5. Which of the following best describes your current employment status?
Employed full-time · Employed part-time · Self-employed · Student · Retired · Unemployed · Prefer not to say

6. Which of the following best describes your annual personal income (in USD, before tax)?
Under $30,000 · $30,000–$59,999 · $60,000–$99,999 · $100,000–$149,999 · $150,000 or more

7. In which country do you currently reside?
Country list

8. Is your primary retail bank a digital-only bank (no branches), or a traditional bank (with branches)?
Digital-only bank · Incumbent bank

9. Which bank is your primary retail bank (the one you use most often for day-to-day banking)?
Free text

10. Have you ever started a banking application (such as for a loan, credit card, or new account) and abandoned it before completing the process?
Yes · No

11. What were the main reasons you abandoned the application? (Select all that apply)
The process took too long · Asked for documents I didn't have readily available · Too many steps or screens · I had to re-enter information the bank should already have · System errors or technical issues · The process felt confusing or unclear · Other (free text)

12. In the past 12 months, how often has your bank asked you to re-enter personal details (name, address, phone number, etc.) that they already have on file?
Never · Once · 2–3 times · 4–5 times · More than 5 times

13. In the past year, have you experienced a visible system delay or loading screen during a routine transaction (such as checking balance, making a transfer, or paying a bill)?
No, never · Yes, once or twice · Yes, occasionally · Yes, frequently

14. Compared to signing up for other digital services (streaming services, e-commerce accounts, mobile phone plans), how would you rate the onboarding experience with your current bank?
Much easier than other services · Somewhat easier · About the same · Somewhat harder · Much harder than other services

15. How long do you expect it should take to open a new bank account entirely on your mobile phone?
Under 5 minutes · 5–10 minutes · 10–20 minutes · 20–30 minutes · More than 30 minutes

16. Which channel do you use most often to interact with your bank?
Mobile app · Desktop/laptop website · Visit to branch · Phone call to customer service · Other

17. How would you rate the overall quality of your bank's mobile app experience?
Excellent · Very good · Good · Fair · Poor

18. Beyond checking balances and making transfers, which of the following have you used your bank's mobile app for in the past 6 months? (Select all that apply)
Applying for a loan or credit card · Opening a new account · Managing investments or savings goals · Setting spending alerts or budgets · Chatting with customer service · Updating personal information · Viewing personalised offers or recommendations · None of the above – I only use it for basic transactions

19. How interested would you be in having banking services embedded directly into other platforms you use daily (such as shopping apps, payroll systems, travel booking sites, or ride-hailing apps)?
Not at all interested · Slightly · Moderately · Very · Extremely interested

20. If it were legally available in your country, how comfortable would you be completing a mortgage application entirely on your mobile phone (assuming the experience were streamlined and simple)?
Not at all comfortable · Slightly · Moderately · Very · Extremely comfortable

21. Thinking about your bank's digital experience over the past two years, would you say it has…
Improved significantly · Improved somewhat · Stayed about the same · Declined somewhat · Declined significantly

22. To what extent do you agree or disagree with the following statement: My bank really knows me and understands my financial needs.
Strongly agree · Somewhat agree · Neither agree nor disagree · Somewhat disagree · Strongly disagree

23. Which of the following types of proactive notifications or alerts have you received from your bank in the past 6 months? (Select all that apply)
Fraud alerts · Spending alerts (e.g. unusual spending detected) · Upcoming bill reminders · Personalised product recommendations · Savings tips based on my transaction history · None of the above

24. How would you rate the relevance of the offers, promotions, or product recommendations your bank sends to you?
Extremely relevant · Somewhat relevant · Neutral · Somewhat irrelevant · Completely irrelevant

25. How willing would you be to share your banking data with trusted third parties (e.g. budgeting apps, retailers, insurers) to enable more personalised financial services?
Not at all willing · Slightly · Moderately · Very · Extremely willing

26. Which of the following incentives or benefits would most encourage you to share additional personal or financial data with your bank? (Select up to 3)
Lower fees or better interest rates · Cashback, rewards or loyalty perks · Personalised financial insights and recommendations · Access to exclusive products or partner offers · Faster product approvals · I would not be willing to share my data, regardless of incentives

27. Would you trust a financial recommendation (such as a savings plan, investment option, or loan product) generated by artificial intelligence (AI)?
Yes, if clearly based on my own data · Yes, even if based on general segments · Maybe · No

F. Questionnaire (cont'd)

28. How important is it to you that your bank provides personalised financial guidance?

Not at all important · Slightly · Moderately · Very · Extremely important

29. Customers who feel their bank 'understands their financial life' are significantly less likely to switch banks. Do you feel your bank understands your financial life?

Yes, completely · Yes, somewhat · No, not really · No, not at all

30. When you make a payment or transfer, how quickly do you expect to receive confirmation?

Instantly (within seconds) · Within 1 minute · Within 5 minutes · Within 30 minutes · I don't expect instant confirmation

31. Have you ever experienced anxiety or concern due to a delayed or pending transaction status?

No, never · Yes, once or twice · Yes, occasionally · Yes, frequently

32. If a banking transaction fails, what is your first reaction?

I assume it's a temporary technical issue and try again · I check if there's a problem with my account or balance · I contact customer service immediately · I worry that I might have been defrauded · Other (free text)

33. When evaluating your bank's speed and reliability, which of the following do you compare it to? (Select all that apply)

Other traditional banks · Digital-only banks or neobanks · Fintech apps · E-commerce platforms · Super-apps · I don't compare it to anything

34. How important is instant and seamless performance when deciding whether to trust your bank?

Not at all important · Slightly · Moderately · Very · Extremely important

35. Rank the following factors in order of importance when choosing or staying with a bank.

Ranked 1–5: Interest rates and fees · Digital experience quality · Speed and reliability of transactions · Brand reputation · Branch network and physical presence

36. How clearly does your bank communicate the fees associated with your account? (e.g. monthly charges, overdraft costs, FX fees, ATM fees etc)

Not at all clearly · Slightly · Moderately · Very · Extremely clearly

37. Would you be willing to pay a monthly subscription fee for a premium banking tier that offered a significantly better experience? (e.g. faster service, richer features, exclusive perks)

Yes, definitely · Yes, probably · Maybe – depends on the price and features · No, probably not · No, I would only use free banking services

38. When you need help with a complex or emotionally sensitive banking issue (such as fraud, bereavement, or a disputed charge), what is your preferred way to get support?

Speak to a human agent immediately · Start digitally but escalate to a human agent · Resolve it entirely through digital channels · Visit a branch in person

39. If you do need to speak to a human agent, how long are you willing to wait before reaching someone knowledgeable?

Under 1 minute · 1–2 minutes · 2–5 minutes · 5–10 minutes · More than 10 minutes is acceptable

40. When contacting your bank for support, how often do you have to repeat your issue to multiple people?

Never · Rarely · Sometimes · Often · Always

41. How interested would you be in a bank that proactively offers you the right financial product at the right life moment? (e.g. a home loan when you're browsing properties, travel insurance when booking a trip)

Not at all interested · Slightly · Moderately · Very · Extremely interested

42. Have you ever experienced inconsistency when switching between channels? (e.g. starting something on mobile and continuing on web, or contacting support after using the app)

No, never · Yes, once or twice · Yes, occasionally · Yes, frequently

43. To what extent do you agree or disagree: My bank plays a meaningful role in major life decisions (buying a home, starting a family, planning retirement).

Strongly agree · Somewhat agree · Neither agree nor disagree · Somewhat disagree · Strongly disagree

44. How likely are you to switch your primary bank in the next 12 months?

Not at all likely · Slightly · Moderately · Very · Extremely likely

45. What is the main reason you stay with your current bank?

Genuine satisfaction with their service · It's too much hassle to switch · I've been with them for a long time · My salary/payroll is connected to this account · Interest rates or rewards are competitive · Branch locations are convenient · Other (free text)

46. How many different financial services providers (banks, neobanks, fintech apps, etc.) do you currently hold accounts or products with?

Just 1 · 2 · 3 · 4 or more

47. After experiencing a poor digital experience with your bank (e.g. app crash, slow transaction, confusing process), what did you do? (Select all that apply)

Nothing – I continued using the bank as before · I complained to customer service · I started exploring other banks · I reduced my usage of that bank's services · I opened an account with another provider · Other (free text)

48. If the process of switching banks were made significantly easier (e.g. automatic transfer of direct debits, seamless account migration), how likely would you be to switch?

Not at all likely · Slightly · Moderately · Very · Extremely likely

49. Would you consolidate all of your financial products (checking, savings, loans, investments, insurance) with a single provider if they could deliver a seamless, intelligent, and connected experience?

Yes, definitely · Yes, probably · Maybe · No, probably not · No, definitely not

50. Overall, how satisfied are you with your primary bank?

Not at all satisfied · Slightly · Moderately · Very · Extremely satisfied

51. How likely are you to recommend your primary bank to a friend or colleague?

Scale of 0–10

52. What is the single most important improvement your bank could make to enhance your experience?

Free text

53. Is there anything else you'd like to share about your banking experience?

Free text

Your contacts

Speak to our team to explore what these findings mean for your bank.

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About Synpulse

Synpulse is a global management consulting firm and trusted partner to financial services providers, committed to helping institutions evolve and capture the potential of the new economy. We guide our clients from strategy to implementation to create impact and value in this rapidly changing environment. As industry consultants with nearly 30 years of experience in technology and business processes, we understand the challenges of implementing new technologies in banking and creating value for customers, employees and shareholders. Leveraging our strong network of over 100 ecosystem partners, we accompany our clients throughout their transformation journey – from strategy and development to implementation and management.

With our tech powerhouse, Synpulse8, we collaborate with our clients to co-create digital experiences with innovative technologies and proprietary methods. Synpulse is powered by the passion and commitment of its more than 1,300 employees from 21 offices who come from over 30 countries. ▪

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